

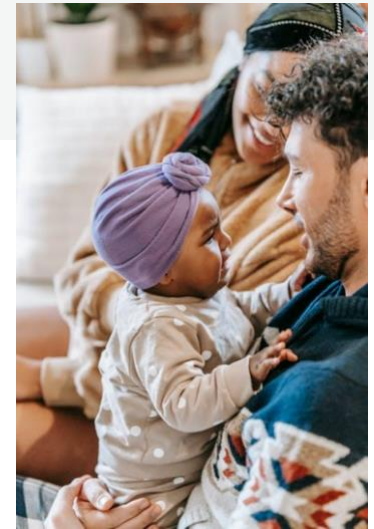


How Home Language(s) Shape Early Intervention Exit: Unpacking Equitable Access

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<https://maihata.github.io/finalproj/>



Purpose: To present demographic disparities in Early Intervention (EI) exit by home language(s) and offer recommendations to advance data equity for historically marginalized communities.

Background: Recent data from the Oregon Department of Education (ODE) revealed that children from homes where languages other than English are spoken have been exiting EI services through certain exit categories at disproportionate rates.

What I Measured: EI serves infants and toddlers (birth to age 3) with disabilities or developmental delays under IDEA Part C. Children exit EI through different pathways, such as **Dismissed for lost contact**, **Moved out**, **Not determined**, **Not eligible**, **Part B eligible**, or **Withdrawn**. Disparities in these exit patterns reveal underlying inequities in engagement patterns.

Framework: Guided by QuantCrit and intersectionality, this study explores how families may experience EI differently, often due to policy and systems.

Key Findings:

- Oregon's EI data system, *ecWeb*, collapses languages other than English, Spanish, Chinese, Russian, Vietnamese, or sign language, plus any language combinations, into "Other". Additionally, race/ethnicity data are often not accurately recorded. These limitations underrepresent children from minoritized communities in data and research.
- Despite these constraints, disparities in Part C exits are evident. American Indian or Alaska Native children show higher odds of **Dismissal due to Lost Contact** (OR = 1.49) compared to Asian children (OR = 0.61) and White children (OR = 0.88). Children from English-only homes had higher odds of **No Longer Eligible**, a category indicating progress beyond eligibility threshold (OR = 1.29), compared to linguistically diverse children (Spanish-only OR = 0.81; other OR = 0.79).
- Between 2013-2023, Oregon exits skewed heavily toward English monolinguals (28,632) and Spanish monolinguals (4,025), with minimal representation of Vietnamese (135), Russian (52), Chinese (39), ASL users (8), and 4,385 in "Other".

Recommendations:

- Make improvements to Oregon's EI data system, *ecWeb*, to represent children and families from marginalized communities more accurately and equitably. Specific improvements are outlined in **GUIDE-EI (Gathering Unbiased Information for Demographic Equity in Early Intervention)**, a data collection protocol developed from this study, and include: expanding language selection options, refining demographic data collection procedures across key touchpoints, and integrating these updates into service coordinators' workflows.
- Strengthen training for service coordinators, EI providers, and support staff on culturally responsive practices in data collection, assessment, and service delivery.